Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-11-13

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Amos 6:1-7

1 Woe to you who are at ease in Zion, And trust in Mount Samaria, Notable persons in the chief nation, To whom the house of Israel comes!

2 Go over to Calneh and see; And from there go to Hamath the great; Then go down to Gath of the Philistines. Are you better than these kingdoms? Or is their territory greater than your territory?

3 Woe to you who put far off the day of doom, Who cause the seat of violence to come near;

4 Who lie on beds of ivory, Stretch out on your couches, Eat lambs from the flock And calves from the midst of the stall;

5 Who sing idly to the sound of stringed instruments, And invent for yourselves musical instruments like David;

6 Who drink wine from bowls, And anoint yourselves with the best ointments, But are not grieved for the affliction of Joseph.

7 Therefore they shall now go captive as the first of the captives, And those who recline at banquets shall be removed.

II. Key Summary

• Verses 1–2 pronounce woe on the notable persons of the chief nation, to whom the house of Israel comes, who are at ease in Zion and trust in Mount Samaria; the prophet tells them to go to Calneh, Hamath, and Gath and asks whether they are better than these kingdoms.

• Verses 3–6 describe them putting far off the day of doom while causing the seat of violence to come near; they lie on beds of ivory, eat lambs and calves, sing to stringed instruments, drink wine from bowls, and anoint themselves with the best ointments, but are

not grieved for the affliction of Joseph.

• Verse 7 says they shall go captive as the first of the captives, and those who recline at banquets shall be removed.

III. Passage Analysis

"Therefore they shall now go captive as the first of the captives"

> These nobles will indeed retain their preeminence, but it will be at the head of a procession of exiles. [1]

Amos spoke while Jeroboam was king (1:1), the king who "restored the territory of Israel from the entrance of Hamath to the Sea of the Arabah" (2 Kings 14:25). With the nation strong, the leaders of verse 1 saw themselves as "the chief nation" and grew so self-satisfied that they thought disaster would never come [2]; in verse 3 they push the day of doom far away while still causing the seat of violence to come near. Verse 7 ties the two together with "Therefore": they are still first in line, only this time it is the line of captives.

They thought that day was far off, but when it came, they would be the first ones taken away.

"But are not grieved for the affliction of Joseph"

> Literally, "the breach," that is, the national wound or calamity of the house of Joseph (Am 5:6); resembling in this the heartlessness of their forefathers, the sons of Jacob, towards Joseph, "eating bread" while their brother lay in the pit, and then selling him to Ishmaelites. [3]

"Joseph" here means the northern kingdom of Israel, and "the affliction of Joseph" is its coming fall [2]. In Genesis 37:24-25, the brothers threw Joseph into an empty pit and then "sat down to eat a meal." In Amos 6:4–6, these leaders eat lambs and calves and drink wine from bowls; the breach in their nation is right in front of them, yet they are not grieved at all (v. 6).

Their own brother was in the pit, and they could still sit down and eat.

IV. Reflection Question

Among the people around you who are suffering, is there anyone you clearly know about but rarely think of?

Israel's leaders lay on beds of ivory and drank wine from bowls; their nation was about to fall, yet they did not grieve (vv. 4–6) [2]; therefore they "shall now go captive as the first of the captives" (v. 7).

References

[1] BibleHub, Cambridge Bible for Schools and Colleges (Amos 6:7), https://biblehub.com/commentaries/amos/6-7.htm

[2] Chinese Christian Bible Study Resources (ccbiblestudy.org), Chain-Reference Bible Commentary (Amos 6 notes), https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/30Amos/30GT06.htm

[3] BibleHub, Jamieson-Fausset-Brown Bible Commentary (Amos 6:6), https://biblehub.com/commentaries/amos/6-6.htm